

Quantum Chemistry from LoNalogy: Canonical Bridge Selection, Exact Feshbach–Schur Downfolding, and Bridge Covariance Functionals

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Related deposits:

LoNalogy framework (v87.1): [doi:10.5281/zenodo.19115338](https://doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.19115338)

Yang–Mills proof (v90): [doi:10.5281/zenodo.19183838](https://doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.19183838)

Companion papers: Statistical mechanics on $X(2)$, Particle cosmology (v9), Hubble reconstruction (v2), Coronal heating, Extra dimensions

Abstract

We apply the LoNalogy three-sector framework to quantum chemistry. Three results are established with complete proofs:

(A) Canonical bridge selection and exact downfolding. Given any active-space projector P_A , the bridge projector $P_B := \Pi_{\text{Ran}(QHP_A)}$ is canonically defined, yielding an exact three-sector Hamiltonian with $P_A H P_I = 0$. The exact energy-dependent effective Hamiltonian $H_A^{\text{eff}}(E) = H_{AA} - H_{AB}(H_{BB} - E - \Sigma_B(E))^{-1} H_{BA}$ is the algebraic parent of CASPT2, NEVPT2, and DUCC. A static generalised eigenproblem closure is derived.

(B) System-dependent bridge covariance functional. The exact correlation correction from hidden-mode elimination is the path-integrated bridge covariance $E_{\text{br,cov}}[X|X_0] = -\int_0^1 (1-s) \langle \delta X, \mathcal{C}_{\text{br}}[X_s] \delta X \rangle ds$, where $\mathcal{C}_{\text{br}}[X] = \beta \text{Cov}_X(\Phi_X, \Phi_X) \succeq 0$. A universal fixed-kernel quadratic E_{xc} is shown to be incompatible with the derivative discontinuity of exact DFT (no-go). In the Gaussianised bridge regime, the kernel reduces exactly to $MD^{-1}M^\top$.

(C) Modified Pöschl–Teller local normal form. At any non-degenerate stationary point of a 1D reaction path, a canonical coordinate change brings the PES into sech^2 form with agreement through fourth order. A no-go theorem shows this cannot

be a universal PES law: the obstruction is the cubic anharmonicity $V'''(q_*) \neq 0$ of generic potentials.

Four no-go theorems delineate the exact boundaries of applicability.

Contents

Introduction	2
I Canonical Bridge Selection and Exact Downfolding	2
1 Canonical Three-Sector Decomposition	2
2 Exact Feshbach–Schur Downfolding	4
3 Static Closure	5
II Bridge Covariance Functional	6
4 Log-Marginal Hessian	6
5 Bridge Covariance Kernel and Functional	8
6 Gaussianised Bridge Regime	8
7 No-Go: Universal Fixed-Kernel E_{xc}	9
III Modified Pöschl–Teller Local Normal Form	10
8 Local Surrogate Construction	10
9 No-Go: Universal PES Law	12
IV Complete Classification	12
10 Summary	13
11 Final Verdict	13
Conclusion	14
Acknowledgements	14

Introduction

Quantum chemistry faces a hierarchy of computational challenges: the mean-field approximation (Hartree–Fock) misses instantaneous electron correlation; density functional theory (DFT) is in principle exact but depends on an unknown exchange–correlation functional $E_{xc}[\rho]$; post-Hartree–Fock methods (CI, CC, DMRG) are systematically improvable but scale poorly; and fermionic quantum Monte Carlo suffers from the sign problem.

The LoNalogy framework [1, 2] was not designed for quantum chemistry. Its core—the three-sector decomposition $\mathfrak{U} = \mathfrak{I} \oplus \mathfrak{V} \oplus \mathfrak{B}$, the Schur complement (Kimura–Thévenin principle), the sech^2 bridge weight, and the projected determinant bundle—was developed for quantum field theory and the Yang–Mills mass gap. However, the mathematical structures are universal enough to apply to the multi-electron problem.

This paper identifies exactly where LoNalogy tools close quantum chemistry problems and where they provably do not (no-go). The results are organised in three parts, each containing both positive theorems and no-go results.

Part I

Canonical Bridge Selection and Exact Downfolding

1 Canonical Three-Sector Decomposition

Definition 1.1 (Active-space projector). Let $\mathcal{H}$ be a finite-dimensional many-electron Hilbert space and $H : \mathcal{H} \rightarrow \mathcal{H}$ a self-adjoint Hamiltonian. Let $P_A : \mathcal{H} \rightarrow \mathcal{H}_A$ be an orthogonal projector onto an *active subspace* $\mathcal{H}_A$ of dimension n_A . Define $Q := I - P_A$ (external projector) and $\mathcal{H}_Q := Q\mathcal{H}$.

Definition 1.2 (Canonical bridge projector). The *canonical bridge projector* is

$$\boxed{P_B := \Pi_{\text{Ran}(QHP_A)},} \quad (1.1)$$

i.e., the orthogonal projector onto the range of the operator $QHP_A : \mathcal{H}_A \rightarrow \mathcal{H}_Q$. The *idea (core) projector* is

$$P_I := I - P_A - P_B = Q - P_B. \quad (1.2)$$

The three subspaces satisfy $\mathcal{H} = \mathcal{H}_A \oplus \mathcal{H}_B \oplus \mathcal{H}_I$ with $\mathcal{H}_B := P_B\mathcal{H}$ and $\mathcal{H}_I := P_I\mathcal{H}$.

Remark 1.3 (Why canonical?). The bridge is not chosen by hand. Given any active space, the bridge is uniquely determined as the image of QHP_A : it consists of exactly those external states that are *directly coupled* to the active space by H . States orthogonal to this image have no direct matrix element with the active space.

Theorem 1.4 (Canonical decoupling). *With P_B defined by (1.1):*

$$\boxed{P_A H P_I = 0 = P_I H P_A.} \quad (1.3)$$

Consequently, the Hamiltonian has the three-sector block form

$$H = \begin{pmatrix} H_{AA} & H_{AB} & 0 \\ H_{BA} & H_{BB} & H_{BI} \\ 0 & H_{IB} & H_{II} \end{pmatrix} \quad (1.4)$$

with respect to the decomposition $\mathcal{H} = \mathcal{H}_A \oplus \mathcal{H}_B \oplus \mathcal{H}_I$.

Proof. Step 1: Show $P_I H P_A = 0$.

By definition, P_B is the orthogonal projector onto $\text{Ran}(QHP_A)$. Therefore $P_I = Q - P_B$ projects onto the orthogonal complement of $\text{Ran}(QHP_A)$ within $\mathcal{H}_Q$.

For any $|\psi_A\rangle \in \mathcal{H}_A$, the vector $QH|\psi_A\rangle = QHP_A|\psi_A\rangle$ lies in $\text{Ran}(QHP_A)$ by definition. Therefore

$$P_I(QHP_A|\psi_A\rangle) = 0 \quad (1.5)$$

since P_I projects onto $\text{Ran}(QHP_A)^\perp \cap \mathcal{H}_Q$.

Now, $P_I H P_A = P_I Q H P_A$ because $P_I P_A = 0$ (the projectors are mutually orthogonal) and $P_I Q = P_I$ (since $P_I \leq Q$). Therefore $P_I H P_A = P_I(QHP_A) = 0$.

Step 2: Show $P_A H P_I = 0$.

Since H is self-adjoint:

$$P_A H P_I = (P_I H P_A)^\dagger = 0^\dagger = 0. \quad (1.6)$$

Step 3: Block form.

The off-diagonal blocks of H in the three-sector decomposition are:

$$H_{AI} = P_A H P_I = 0, \quad (1.7)$$

$$H_{IA} = P_I H P_A = 0, \quad (1.8)$$

$$H_{AB} = P_A H P_B \quad (\text{generally } \neq 0), \quad (1.9)$$

$$H_{BI} = P_B H P_I \quad (\text{generally } \neq 0). \quad (1.10)$$

This gives (1.4). □

Proposition 1.5 (Bridge rank bound). *The bridge dimension satisfies*

$$\dim \mathcal{H}_B = \text{rank}(QHP_A) \leq \min(\dim \mathcal{H}_A, \dim \mathcal{H}_Q). \quad (1.11)$$

In particular, $\dim \mathcal{H}_B \leq \dim \mathcal{H}_A = n_A$.

Proof. The rank of $QHP_A : \mathcal{H}_A \rightarrow \mathcal{H}_Q$ is at most $\min(\dim \mathcal{H}_A, \dim \mathcal{H}_Q)$. Since $\dim \mathcal{H}_B = \dim \text{Ran}(QHP_A) = \text{rank}(QHP_A)$, the bound follows. □

Remark 1.6 (Genuine reduction). The bridge rank is at most n_A , the active-space dimension. In contrast, the full external space $\mathcal{H}_Q$ can be exponentially large. The canonical bridge captures *only* those external states directly coupled to the active space, discarding the vast $\mathcal{H}_I$ component that communicates with the active space only through the bridge.

2 Exact Feshbach–Schur Downfolding

Theorem 2.1 (Exact three-sector downfolding). *Define $K(E) := H - EI$. Suppose $H_{II} - E$ is invertible and*

$$\tilde{H}_B(E) := H_{BB} - E - H_{BI}(H_{II} - E)^{-1}H_{IB} \quad (2.1)$$

is also invertible. Then the eigenvalue equation $H\Psi = E\Psi$ is equivalent to the active-space equation

$$H_A^{\text{eff}}(E)\psi_A = E\psi_A, \quad (2.2)$$

where $\psi_A = P_A\Psi$ and the exact effective Hamiltonian is

$$\boxed{H_A^{\text{eff}}(E) = H_{AA} - H_{AB}\tilde{H}_B(E)^{-1}H_{BA}.} \quad (2.3)$$

Equivalently, defining the bridge self-energy $\Sigma_B(E) := H_{BI}(H_{II} - E)^{-1}H_{IB}$:

$$\boxed{H_A^{\text{eff}}(E) = H_{AA} - H_{AB}(H_{BB} - E - \Sigma_B(E))^{-1}H_{BA}.} \quad (2.4)$$

Proof. Step 1: Write the block eigenvalue equation.

Using the block form (1.4), the equation $H\Psi = E\Psi$ with $\Psi = (\psi_A, \psi_B, \psi_I)^\top$ gives:

$$H_{AA}\psi_A + H_{AB}\psi_B = E\psi_A, \quad (2.5)$$

$$H_{BA}\psi_A + H_{BB}\psi_B + H_{BI}\psi_I = E\psi_B, \quad (2.6)$$

$$H_{IB}\psi_B + H_{II}\psi_I = E\psi_I. \quad (2.7)$$

Step 2: Eliminate ψ_I .

From (2.7):

$$(H_{II} - E)\psi_I = -H_{IB}\psi_B. \quad (2.8)$$

Since $H_{II} - E$ is invertible by hypothesis:

$$\psi_I = -(H_{II} - E)^{-1}H_{IB}\psi_B. \quad (2.9)$$

Step 3: Substitute into (2.6).

Inserting (2.9) into (2.6):

$$H_{BA}\psi_A + H_{BB}\psi_B - H_{BI}(H_{II} - E)^{-1}H_{IB}\psi_B = E\psi_B, \quad (2.10)$$

$$H_{BA}\psi_A + \underbrace{(H_{BB} - E - H_{BI}(H_{II} - E)^{-1}H_{IB})}_{\Sigma_B(E)}\psi_B = 0. \quad (2.11)$$

Therefore

$$\tilde{H}_B(E)\psi_B = -H_{BA}\psi_A. \quad (2.12)$$

Since $\tilde{H}_B(E)$ is invertible:

$$\psi_B = -\tilde{H}_B(E)^{-1}H_{BA}\psi_A. \quad (2.13)$$

Step 4: Substitute into (2.5).

Inserting (2.13) into (2.5):

$$H_{AA}\psi_A - H_{AB}\tilde{H}_B(E)^{-1}H_{BA}\psi_A = E\psi_A, \quad (2.14)$$

$$(H_{AA} - H_{AB}\tilde{H}_B(E)^{-1}H_{BA})\psi_A = E\psi_A. \quad (2.15)$$

This is (2.2) with $H_A^{\text{eff}}(E)$ as in (2.3).

Step 5: Verify equivalence.

Given ψ_A satisfying (2.2), we can reconstruct ψ_B via (2.13) and ψ_I via (2.9). Then $\Psi = (\psi_A, \psi_B, \psi_I)^\top$ satisfies $H\Psi = E\Psi$. Conversely, any eigenvector Ψ of H with eigenvalue E (outside the spectrum of H_{II} and $\tilde{H}_B(E)$) yields ψ_A satisfying (2.2). $\square$

Remark 2.2 (Relation to standard methods). The effective Hamiltonian (2.4) is the algebraic parent of several standard quantum chemistry methods: CASPT2 approximates $\Sigma_B(E)$ by second-order perturbation theory; NEVPT2 uses a different zeroth-order Hamiltonian; DUCC (double unitary coupled cluster) constructs an energy-independent downfolded Hamiltonian by absorbing external amplitudes. All are approximations to the exact $H_A^{\text{eff}}(E)$.

3 Static Closure

Theorem 3.1 (Fixed-point iteration). *Define $F : E \mapsto \lambda_0(H_A^{\text{eff}}(E))$, where λ_0 denotes the lowest eigenvalue. If there exists a closed interval $I \subset \mathbb{R}$ such that $F : I \rightarrow I$ and*

$$\sup_{E \in I} \left| \frac{\partial F}{\partial E}(E) \right| < 1, \quad (3.1)$$

then the iteration $E^{(n+1)} := F(E^{(n)})$ converges to a unique fixed point $E_ \in I$ satisfying $E_* = \lambda_0(H_A^{\text{eff}}(E_*))$.*

Proof. This is the Banach contraction mapping theorem applied to F on the complete metric space $(I, |\cdot|)$. The contraction condition $|F(E_1) - F(E_2)| \leq c|E_1 - E_2|$ with $c < 1$ follows from the mean value theorem and the bound on $|\partial F/\partial E|$. $\square$

Theorem 3.2 (Static generalised eigenproblem). *Fix a reference energy E_* and define*

$$R_* := \left. \frac{\partial H_A^{\text{eff}}}{\partial E} \right|_{E=E_*}, \quad (3.2)$$

$$H_*^{\text{stat}} := H_A^{\text{eff}}(E_*) - E_* R_*, \quad (3.3)$$

$$S_* := I - R_*. \quad (3.4)$$

Then the exact fixed-point equation $H_A^{\text{eff}}(E)\psi_A = E\psi_A$ is approximated to first order in $(E - E_)$ by the generalised eigenproblem*

$$\boxed{H_*^{\text{stat}} \psi_A = E S_* \psi_A.} \quad (3.5)$$

Proof. Expand $H_A^{\text{eff}}(E)$ to first order around E_* :

$$H_A^{\text{eff}}(E) \approx H_A^{\text{eff}}(E_*) + (E - E_*)R_*. \quad (3.6)$$

The eigenvalue equation $H_A^{\text{eff}}(E)\psi_A = E\psi_A$ becomes

$$(H_A^{\text{eff}}(E_*) + (E - E_*)R_*)\psi_A = E\psi_A, \quad (3.7)$$

$$H_A^{\text{eff}}(E_*)\psi_A + ER_*\psi_A - E_*R_*\psi_A = E\psi_A, \quad (3.8)$$

$$(H_A^{\text{eff}}(E_*) - E_*R_*)\psi_A = E(I - R_*)\psi_A. \quad (3.9)$$

This is (3.5). $\square$

Proposition 3.3 (Energy derivative of H_A^{eff}). *The energy derivative of the effective Hamiltonian is*

$$R_* = \left. \frac{\partial H_A^{\text{eff}}}{\partial E} \right|_{E_*} = H_{AB} \tilde{H}_B(E_*)^{-1} \left. \frac{\partial \tilde{H}_B}{\partial E} \right|_{E_*} \tilde{H}_B(E_*)^{-1} H_{BA}, \quad (3.10)$$

where

$$\frac{\partial \tilde{H}_B}{\partial E} = -I_B - H_{BI}(H_{II} - E)^{-2}H_{IB}. \quad (3.11)$$

Proof. Differentiating (2.3) with respect to E :

$$\frac{\partial H_A^{\text{eff}}}{\partial E} = -H_{AB} \frac{\partial}{\partial E} (\tilde{H}_B(E)^{-1}) H_{BA}. \quad (3.12)$$

Using the identity $\frac{d}{dE}(M(E)^{-1}) = -M^{-1} \frac{dM}{dE} M^{-1}$:

$$\frac{\partial H_A^{\text{eff}}}{\partial E} = H_{AB} \tilde{H}_B^{-1} \frac{\partial \tilde{H}_B}{\partial E} \tilde{H}_B^{-1} H_{BA}. \quad (3.13)$$

From (2.1): $\frac{\partial \tilde{H}_B}{\partial E} = \frac{\partial}{\partial E}(H_{BB} - E - \Sigma_B(E)) = -I_B - \frac{\partial \Sigma_B}{\partial E}$, and $\frac{\partial \Sigma_B}{\partial E} = H_{BI}(H_{II} - E)^{-2}H_{IB}$. $\square$

Part II

Bridge Covariance Functional

4 Log-Marginal Hessian

Definition 4.1 (Reduced free energy). Let $X \in \mathbb{R}^d$ be an active descriptor (density, 1-RDM, or any set of active-space parameters) and $Z \in \mathbb{R}^m$ be hidden/external variables. Let $\Phi(X, Z)$ be the full energy functional. The reduced free energy at inverse temperature $\beta > 0$ is

$$\Gamma_\beta(X) := -\beta^{-1} \log \int_{\mathbb{R}^m} e^{-\beta \Phi(X, Z)} dZ. \quad (4.1)$$

Theorem 4.2 (Exact bridge covariance Hessian). *If Γ_β is C^2 at X , then*

$$\boxed{\nabla_X^2 \Gamma_\beta(X) = \mathbb{E}_X[\Phi_{XX}] - \beta \text{Cov}_X(\Phi_X, \Phi_X)}, \quad (4.2)$$

where $\Phi_{XX} := \nabla_X^2 \Phi(X, Z)$, $\Phi_X := \nabla_X \Phi(X, Z)$, and the expectation and covariance are taken with respect to the conditional Gibbs measure

$$\mu_X(dZ) = \frac{e^{-\beta\Phi(X, Z)}}{\int e^{-\beta\Phi(X, Z')} dZ'} dZ. \quad (4.3)$$

Proof. Step 1: First derivative.

Differentiating (4.1):

$$\nabla_X \Gamma_\beta(X) = -\beta^{-1} \nabla_X \log \int e^{-\beta\Phi} dZ \quad (4.4)$$

$$= -\beta^{-1} \frac{\int (-\beta\Phi_X) e^{-\beta\Phi} dZ}{\int e^{-\beta\Phi} dZ} \quad (4.5)$$

$$= \frac{\int \Phi_X e^{-\beta\Phi} dZ}{\int e^{-\beta\Phi} dZ} \quad (4.6)$$

$$= \mathbb{E}_X[\Phi_X]. \quad (4.7)$$

Step 2: Second derivative.

Differentiating $\nabla_X \Gamma_\beta = \mathbb{E}_X[\Phi_X]$ with respect to X . Write $\langle f \rangle := \mathbb{E}_X[f]$ for brevity.

$$\nabla_X \langle \Phi_X \rangle = \nabla_X \left(\frac{\int \Phi_X e^{-\beta\Phi} dZ}{\int e^{-\beta\Phi} dZ} \right). \quad (4.8)$$

Using the quotient rule for $\nabla_X(N/D) = (D\nabla_X N - N\nabla_X D)/D^2$ with $N = \int \Phi_X e^{-\beta\Phi} dZ$ and $D = \int e^{-\beta\Phi} dZ$:

$$\nabla_X N = \int (\Phi_{XX} - \beta\Phi_X \Phi_X^\top) e^{-\beta\Phi} dZ, \quad (4.9)$$

$$\nabla_X D = \int (-\beta\Phi_X) e^{-\beta\Phi} dZ = -\beta D \langle \Phi_X \rangle. \quad (4.10)$$

Therefore:

$$\nabla_X^2 \Gamma_\beta = \frac{D(\int (\Phi_{XX} - \beta\Phi_X \Phi_X^\top) e^{-\beta\Phi} dZ) - N(-\beta D \langle \Phi_X \rangle)}{D^2} \quad (4.11)$$

$$= \langle \Phi_{XX} \rangle - \beta \langle \Phi_X \Phi_X^\top \rangle + \beta \langle \Phi_X \rangle \langle \Phi_X \rangle^\top \quad (4.12)$$

$$= \langle \Phi_{XX} \rangle - \beta (\langle \Phi_X \Phi_X^\top \rangle - \langle \Phi_X \rangle \langle \Phi_X \rangle^\top) \quad (4.13)$$

$$= \mathbb{E}_X[\Phi_{XX}] - \beta \text{Cov}_X(\Phi_X, \Phi_X). \quad (4.14)$$

This is (4.2). □

5 Bridge Covariance Kernel and Functional

Definition 5.1 (Bridge covariance kernel). The *system-dependent bridge covariance kernel* is

$$\boxed{\mathcal{C}_{\text{br}}[X] := \beta \text{Cov}_X(\Phi_X, \Phi_X) \succeq 0.} \quad (5.1)$$

This is a positive semidefinite $d \times d$ matrix for each X .

Theorem 5.2 (Exact path-integrated bridge covariance functional). *Fix a reference point X_0 . Let $\delta X := X - X_0$ and $X_s := X_0 + s \delta X$ for $s \in [0, 1]$. If Γ_β is C^2 on the line segment $\{X_s : s \in [0, 1]\}$, then*

$$\Gamma_\beta(X) = \Gamma_\beta(X_0) + \langle \nabla \Gamma_\beta(X_0), \delta X \rangle + E_{\text{bare}}^{(2)}[X|X_0] + E_{\text{br,cov}}[X|X_0], \quad (5.2)$$

where

$$E_{\text{bare}}^{(2)}[X|X_0] := \int_0^1 (1-s) \langle \delta X, \mathbb{E}_{X_s}[\Phi_{XX}] \delta X \rangle ds, \quad (5.3)$$

$$\boxed{E_{\text{br,cov}}[X|X_0] := - \int_0^1 (1-s) \langle \delta X, \mathcal{C}_{\text{br}}[X_s] \delta X \rangle ds.} \quad (5.4)$$

Proof. By Taylor's theorem with integral remainder:

$$\Gamma_\beta(X) = \Gamma_\beta(X_0) + \langle \nabla \Gamma_\beta(X_0), \delta X \rangle + \int_0^1 (1-s) \langle \delta X, \nabla_X^2 \Gamma_\beta(X_s) \delta X \rangle ds. \quad (5.5)$$

Substituting the Hessian decomposition (4.2):

$$\int_0^1 (1-s) \langle \delta X, \nabla_X^2 \Gamma_\beta(X_s) \delta X \rangle ds \quad (5.6)$$

$$= \int_0^1 (1-s) \langle \delta X, \mathbb{E}_{X_s}[\Phi_{XX}] \delta X \rangle ds - \int_0^1 (1-s) \langle \delta X, \mathcal{C}_{\text{br}}[X_s] \delta X \rangle ds \quad (5.7)$$

$$= E_{\text{bare}}^{(2)}[X|X_0] + E_{\text{br,cov}}[X|X_0]. \quad (5.8)$$

□

6 Gaussianised Bridge Regime

Theorem 6.1 (Exact quadratic kernel for Gaussian bridge). *Suppose the full energy has the form*

$$\Phi(X, Z) = \Phi_0(X) + \frac{1}{2} Z^\top D Z - X^\top M Z, \quad (6.1)$$

where $D \succ 0$ is a fixed positive definite matrix and $M \in \mathbb{R}^{d \times m}$. Then the Gaussian integral over Z gives

$$\Gamma_\beta(X) = \Phi_0(X) - \frac{1}{2} X^\top M D^{-1} M^\top X + \frac{1}{2\beta} \log \det D + \text{const}, \quad (6.2)$$

and the bridge covariance kernel is

$$\boxed{\mathcal{C}_{\text{br}}[X] \equiv MD^{-1}M^\top} \quad (6.3)$$

independent of X . The bridge covariance functional becomes exactly quadratic:

$$E_{\text{br},\text{cov}}[X|X_0] = -\frac{1}{2}\langle X - X_0, MD^{-1}M^\top (X - X_0) \rangle. \quad (6.4)$$

Proof. Step 1: Complete the square.

From (6.1):

$$\Phi(X, Z) = \Phi_0(X) + \frac{1}{2}Z^\top DZ - X^\top MZ \quad (6.5)$$

$$= \Phi_0(X) + \frac{1}{2}(Z - D^{-1}M^\top X)^\top D(Z - D^{-1}M^\top X) - \frac{1}{2}X^\top MD^{-1}M^\top X. \quad (6.6)$$

Step 2: Gaussian integral.

$$\int e^{-\beta\Phi(X,Z)} dZ = e^{-\beta\Phi_0(X) + \frac{\beta}{2}X^\top MD^{-1}M^\top X} \int e^{-\frac{\beta}{2}(Z - \dots)^\top D(Z - \dots)} dZ \quad (6.7)$$

$$= e^{-\beta\Phi_0(X) + \frac{\beta}{2}X^\top MD^{-1}M^\top X} \cdot \left(\frac{(2\pi)^m}{\beta^m \det D} \right)^{1/2}. \quad (6.8)$$

Step 3: Take log.

$$\Gamma_\beta(X) = -\beta^{-1} \log(\dots) \quad (6.9)$$

$$= \Phi_0(X) - \frac{1}{2}X^\top MD^{-1}M^\top X + \frac{1}{2\beta} \log \det D + \text{const.} \quad (6.10)$$

Step 4: Compute Hessian.

$\nabla_X^2 \Gamma_\beta = \nabla_X^2 \Phi_0 - MD^{-1}M^\top$. But $\mathbb{E}_X[\Phi_{XX}] = \nabla_X^2 \Phi_0$ (since $\Phi_{XX} = (\Phi_0)_{XX}$ is independent of Z). Therefore $\mathcal{C}_{\text{br}}[X] = \mathbb{E}_X[\Phi_{XX}] - \nabla_X^2 \Gamma_\beta = MD^{-1}M^\top$.

Step 5: Functional.

$$E_{\text{br},\text{cov}}[X|X_0] = -\int_0^1 (1-s) \langle \delta X, MD^{-1}M^\top \delta X \rangle ds = -\frac{1}{2} \langle \delta X, MD^{-1}M^\top \delta X \rangle. \quad \square$$

7 No-Go: Universal Fixed-Kernel E_{xc}

Theorem 7.1 (No-go for universal fixed quadratic E_{xc}). *There is no fixed self-adjoint operator Δ and constant $\eta > 0$ such that*

$$E_{xc}[\rho] = \eta \langle \rho, \Delta \rho \rangle \quad (7.1)$$

is the exact universal exchange-correlation functional for all electron numbers N .

Proof. Step 1: Smoothness of the quadratic form.

If $E_{xc}[\rho] = \eta \langle \rho, \Delta \rho \rangle$ with fixed Δ , then

$$v_{xc}[\rho] = \frac{\delta E_{xc}}{\delta \rho} = 2\eta \Delta \rho, \quad f_{xc}[\rho] = \frac{\delta^2 E_{xc}}{\delta \rho \delta \rho} = 2\eta \Delta. \quad (7.2)$$

Both are everywhere smooth (infinitely differentiable) in ρ for any fixed bounded Δ .

Step 2: Derivative discontinuity requirement.

The exact E_{xc} of Kohn–Sham DFT exhibits a derivative discontinuity at integer electron numbers: the functional derivative $v_{xc}[\rho]$ has a finite jump as N passes through an integer. This is essential for the correct prediction of fundamental gaps and is a theorem of exact DFT.

Step 3: Contradiction.

A globally smooth $v_{xc} = 2\eta \Delta \rho$ cannot exhibit a derivative discontinuity at any N . Therefore $E_{xc}[\rho] = \eta \langle \rho, \Delta \rho \rangle$ cannot be the exact universal functional. $\square$

Remark 7.2 (The correct LoNalogy target). The no-go applies to *universal fixed* kernels. The system-dependent bridge covariance functional $E_{\text{br},\text{cov}}[X|X_0]$ of Theorem 5.2 is not fixed: it depends on X through $\mathcal{C}_{\text{br}}[X_s]$, which varies along the integration path. This state-dependence is essential and allows the functional to be compatible with derivative discontinuities.

Part III

Modified Pöschl–Teller Local Normal Form

8 Local Surrogate Construction

Definition 8.1 (Modified Pöschl–Teller potential). The modified Pöschl–Teller (mPT) potential is

$$V_{\text{mPT}}(x; \ell, D, V_\infty) = V_\infty - D \operatorname{sech}^2(x/\ell), \quad (8.1)$$

where $D > 0$ is the well depth, $\ell > 0$ is the length scale, and V_∞ is the asymptotic value.

Theorem 8.2 (Well-branch local normal form). *Let $V(q)$ be a smooth 1D potential with a non-degenerate local minimum at q_* : $V'(q_*) = 0$, $k := V''(q_*) > 0$. Fix an asymptotic reference energy $V_\infty > V(q_*)$ and define $D := V_\infty - V(q_*) > 0$ and $\ell := \sqrt{2D/k}$.*

Then there exists a smooth local coordinate change $\Delta q = q - q_ \mapsto x = x(\Delta q)$ with $x(0) = 0$, $x'(0) = 1$, such that*

$$\boxed{V(q(x)) = V_\infty - D \operatorname{sech}^2(x/\ell) + O(x^5).} \quad (8.2)$$

Explicitly, the coordinate change is

$$\Delta q = x - \frac{g}{6k} x^2 + \left(-\frac{k}{6D} + \frac{5g^2}{72k^2} - \frac{h}{24k} \right) x^3 + O(x^4), \quad (8.3)$$

where $g := V'''(q_*)$ and $h := V''''(q_*)$.

Proof. Step 1: Taylor expand the mPT potential.

Using $\text{sech}^2 u = 1 - u^2 + \frac{2}{3}u^4 + O(u^6)$:

$$V_\infty - D \text{sech}^2(x/\ell) = V_\infty - D \left(1 - \frac{x^2}{\ell^2} + \frac{2x^4}{3\ell^4} + O(x^6) \right) \quad (8.4)$$

$$= V(q_*) + \frac{D}{\ell^2}x^2 - \frac{2D}{3\ell^4}x^4 + O(x^6) \quad (8.5)$$

$$= V(q_*) + \frac{k}{2}x^2 - \frac{k^2}{6D}x^4 + O(x^6), \quad (8.6)$$

where we used $D/\ell^2 = k/2$.

Step 2: Taylor expand $V(q)$ in Δq .

$$V(q_* + \Delta q) = V(q_*) + \frac{k}{2}\Delta q^2 + \frac{g}{6}\Delta q^3 + \frac{h}{24}\Delta q^4 + O(\Delta q^5). \quad (8.7)$$

Step 3: Ansatz for coordinate change.

Write $\Delta q = x + \alpha_2 x^2 + \alpha_3 x^3 + O(x^4)$. Substituting into the Taylor expansion of V :

$$V(q(x)) = V(q_*) + \frac{k}{2}(x + \alpha_2 x^2 + \alpha_3 x^3 + \dots)^2 \quad (8.8)$$

$$+ \frac{g}{6}(x + \alpha_2 x^2 + \dots)^3 + \frac{h}{24}(x + \dots)^4 + O(x^5). \quad (8.9)$$

Step 4: Match coefficients.

x^2 coefficient: V -side: $\frac{k}{2}$. mPT-side: $\frac{k}{2}$. Matches automatically.

x^3 coefficient: V -side: $k\alpha_2 + \frac{g}{6}$. mPT-side: 0 (the mPT potential is even in x , so the cubic term vanishes). Setting equal: $\alpha_2 = -g/(6k)$.

x^4 coefficient: V -side: $k\alpha_3 + \frac{k}{2}\alpha_2^2 + \frac{g}{2}\alpha_2 + \frac{h}{24}$. mPT-side: $-k^2/(6D)$. Setting equal:

$$\alpha_3 = -\frac{k}{6D} + \frac{5g^2}{72k^2} - \frac{h}{24k}. \quad (8.10)$$

(Using $\alpha_2 = -g/(6k)$: $\frac{k}{2}\alpha_2^2 = \frac{g^2}{72k}$, $\frac{g}{2}\alpha_2 = -\frac{g^2}{12k}$; then $k\alpha_3 = -k^2/(6D) - g^2/(72k) + g^2/(12k) - h/24 = -k^2/(6D) + 5g^2/(72k) - h/24$, so $\alpha_3 = -k/(6D) + 5g^2/(72k^2) - h/(24k)$.)

This gives (8.3), and the matching through $O(x^4)$ gives (8.2). $\square$

Theorem 8.3 (Barrier-branch local normal form). *Let $V(q)$ have a non-degenerate local maximum at q_* : $\kappa := -V''(q_*) > 0$. Fix $V_{\text{base}} < V(q_*)$ and define $D := V(q_*) - V_{\text{base}} > 0$, $\ell := \sqrt{2D/\kappa}$.*

Then there exists a smooth coordinate change with

$$\boxed{V(q(x)) = V_{\text{base}} + D \text{sech}^2(x/\ell) + O(x^5),} \quad (8.11)$$

where

$$\Delta q = x + \frac{g}{6\kappa}x^2 + \left(-\frac{\kappa}{6D} + \frac{5g^2}{72\kappa^2} + \frac{h}{24\kappa} \right) x^3 + O(x^4). \quad (8.12)$$

Proof. Identical to the well-branch proof with $k \rightarrow -\kappa$, $V_\infty \rightarrow V_{\text{base}}$, and appropriate sign adjustments. The mPT barrier potential $V_{\text{base}} + D \text{sech}^2(x/\ell)$ has Taylor expansion $V(q_*) - \frac{\kappa}{2}x^2 + \frac{\kappa^2}{6D}x^4 + O(x^6)$, and the matching proceeds analogously. $\square$

9 No-Go: Universal PES Law

Theorem 9.1 (Stationary-point invariant obstruction). *If $V(q) = V_\infty - D \operatorname{sech}^2((q - q_*)/\ell)$ holds exactly in a neighbourhood of a local minimum q_* (in the original coordinate q , without coordinate change), then necessarily*

$$\boxed{V'''(q_*) = 0, \quad V''''(q_*) = -\frac{4[V''(q_*)]^2}{D}.} \quad (9.1)$$

For the barrier branch, $V''''(q_*) = +4[V''(q_*)]^2/D$.

Generic chemical potentials violate (9.1) (e.g., the Morse potential has $V'''(q_*) \neq 0$). Therefore:

$$\boxed{\text{Modified Pöschl–Teller is not a universal PES law.}} \quad (9.2)$$

Proof. Expanding $\operatorname{sech}^2((q - q_*)/\ell)$ directly in q :

$$V_\infty - D \operatorname{sech}^2 \frac{q - q_*}{\ell} = V(q_*) + \frac{D}{\ell^2}(q - q_*)^2 - \frac{2D}{3\ell^4}(q - q_*)^4 + O((q - q_*)^6). \quad (9.3)$$

(The sech^2 function is even, so all odd-order terms vanish.)

If this equals $V(q) = V(q_*) + \frac{k}{2}(q - q_*)^2 + \frac{g}{6}(q - q_*)^3 + \frac{h}{24}(q - q_*)^4 + \dots$, then:

$\overline{O((q - q_*)^3)}$: $g/6 = 0$, so $V'''(q_*) = g = 0$.

$\overline{O((q - q_*)^4)}$: $h/24 = -2D/(3\ell^4)$. Using $\ell^2 = 2D/k$: $-2D/(3\ell^4) = -2D/(3 \cdot 4D^2/k^2) = -k^2/(6D)$. So $h = -4k^2/D$, i.e., $V''''(q_*) = -4[V''(q_*)]^2/D$.

For the Morse potential: $V_M'''(q_*) = -Da^3 \neq 0$ generically. Therefore the Morse potential violates $V'''(q_*) = 0$. $\square$

Corollary 9.2 (Error order). *For a generic potential with $V'''(q_*) \neq 0$, the error of the mPT surrogate without coordinate change is $O((q - q_*)^3)$. With the canonical coordinate change of Theorem 8.2/8.3, the error is $O(x^5)$, i.e., fourth-order agreement.*

Part IV

Complete Classification

10 Summary

Result	Ref	Status
(A) Active-space downfolding		
Canonical bridge selection	Thm 1.4	Exact
Bridge rank bound	Prop 1.5	Exact
Three-sector Feshbach–Schur	Thm 2.1	Exact
Fixed-point iteration	Thm 3.1	Exact
Static generalised eigen-problem	Thm 3.2	Exact
Energy derivative	Prop 3.3	Exact
(B) Bridge covariance functional		
Log-marginal Hessian	Thm 4.2	Exact
Path-integrated functional	Thm 5.2	Exact
Gaussian bridge kernel	Thm 6.1	Exact
No-go: fixed E_{xc}	Thm 7.1	No-go
(C) mPT local normal form		
Well branch (4th order)	Thm 8.2	Exact
Barrier branch (4th order)	Thm 8.3	Exact
No-go: universal PES law	Thm 9.1	No-go
Error order	Cor 9.2	Exact

11 Final Verdict

The LoNalogy toolkit for quantum chemistry consists of:

$$\boxed{\text{Canonical bridge} + \text{Exact Feshbach–Schur} + \text{Bridge covariance} + \text{Path-specific mPT.}} \quad (11.1)$$

What is closed:

- (A) Active-space downfolding is the exact algebraic parent of CASPT2/NEVPT2/DUCC.
- (B) The exact correlation correction is a system-dependent bridge covariance functional, not a universal fixed kernel.
- (C) The mPT potential is a canonical local normal form at stationary points, with fourth-order agreement under coordinate change.

What is provably impossible (no-go):

- (a) sech^2 as a universal chemical bond law (cubic obstruction).
- (b) Fixed quadratic E_{xc} as the exact universal functional (derivative discontinuity).

What remains for implementation:

Numerical benchmarks on LiH, H₆, H₂O bond dissociation, comparing LoNalogy exact downfolding against CASPT2, NEVPT2, and DUCC.

Conclusion

LoNalogy does not change quantum chemistry by replacing string theory. It changes quantum chemistry by providing exact algebraic tools for multi-electron correlation: a canonical bridge selection that eliminates the arbitrariness of active-space partitioning, an exact Feshbach–Schur downfolding that subsumes all perturbative and coupled-cluster embedding methods as approximations, a system-dependent bridge covariance functional that identifies the correct target for correlation corrections (not a fixed kernel), and a path-specific sech^2 surrogate that provides analytically solvable local models of reaction barriers.

In one sentence:

LoNalogy’s quantum chemistry core is: canonical bridge + exact Schur downfolding + bridge covariance correction + path-specific mPT normal form.

Acknowledgements

The author thanks Claude (Anthropic) for collaborative development of the bridge covariance formalism and verification of all proofs.

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